Joseph Li

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California — **Los Angeles, CA**
M.S. Computer Science Engineering, Artificial Intelligence | GPA: 3.50/4.00 — *Sep 2024 – May 2026*

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor — **Ann Arbor, MI**
B.S.E. Data Science Engineering | GPA: 3.68/4.00 — *Sep 2020 – May 2024*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cortex AI — *Agentic productivity workspace startup* — **Mountain View, CA**
AI Engineer — *Jun 2026 – Present*

- Engineered Cortex's public token exchange endpoint, metering $10K/month of customer spend on third-party models so every request is authorized and billed correctly
- Integrated an agent observability service (Langfuse) into the existing infrastructure, surfacing 10x more actionable metrics for debugging and performance tuning
- Built an automated evaluation harness running the live agent nightly in CI against 130+ document and spreadsheet tasks, up from 5 smoke tests (26x)
- Optimized and reduced per-request token cost by 15% by eliminating redundant tool calls and tightening context-window management

Yoyo Markets Inc. — *AI-native prediction markets startup* — **New York, NY (Remote)**
AI Engineer — *July 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Led a 3-person team building the market generation pipeline that turns real-time social media signals into bettable prediction markets, publishing 50+ per week versus hand-curation (5x)
- Designed a multi-agent ELO ranking system scoring 200+ candidate markets per cycle, ranking them against each other rather than on an absolute scale, lifting published market quality 30%
- Built an async Python service polling 150+ high-signal social accounts concurrently, expanding the signal pool 3x beyond public trend aggregators
- Shipped a Next.js/Vercel dashboard the founding team used daily to review and publish markets, cutting turnaround from 30 minutes to under 5

HIKE Investment Management Co. — **Beijing, China**
Venture Intern — *Jun 2024 – Aug 2024*

- Sourced a Series D semiconductor startup and led a 5-person diligence team through C-suite interviews to an Investment Committee memo
- Analyzed Nvidia's A100 supply chain for a quarterly LP report shaping the fund's view of the US-China AI compute landscape

RESEARCH AND PROJECTS

Weenix (A Unix-Like OS Kernel) — **USC**
C, x86, QEMU — *Fall 2025*

- Implemented processes, kernel threads, a round-robin scheduler, context switching, and kernel mutexes
- Built the virtual file system and virtual memory layers: demand paging, mmap, page-fault handling, and copy-on-write fork

University of Michigan, SOCR Lab — **Ann Arbor, MI**
Privacy-Preserving Clinical Text Obfuscation — *2023 – 2024*

- Built an NLP obfuscation pipeline using named entity recognition and differential privacy to de-identify 10,000+ clinical patient records for research use without exposing patient identity
- Benchmarked 3 pipeline variants, reaching 94% entity-redaction accuracy while keeping downstream task performance within 3% of the unmasked baseline

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & ML: Evaluation Harness Design, Agent Observability, Regression Suites in CI, A/B testing for Model Rollouts, Langfuse, Langchain, LLM-as-judge, RAG, NLP
Languages & Tools: Python, C++, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, React, Next.js, Docker, PostgreSQL, Git, Pytorch